



PROGRESS REPORT

Research institutions: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-02

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28 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** on it in its own report.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A High Council of Scientists was installed at the Presidency on 20 June 2026. Full record The council did not exist at the window's opening. 2026-06-20 - it was installed at the Presidency. No membership, remit, first opinion or reporting arrangement is published. It sits alongside a fifteen-member scientific and technical committee seated at the high commission for digitalisation in October 2025 and a national artificial-intelligence research and innovation strategy drawn up by 150 experts - three advisory bodies of academics in a year, none of which has published anything the base can point to.	Advanced
Botswana	The national research agenda spent P9.5m across the same 45 projects in the year, five completed and none added. Full record 2026-03-25 — P9.5m was spent across 45 projects, five completed and no new projects added, on an agenda Cabinet approved in July 2025 with eight focus areas and 22 thematic priorities. The 45 were approved in 2024 and carried forward, so the project count is unchanged for a second year. A research agenda that adds nothing in a year is not a pipeline. Nothing on this ledger records a think tank, a policy institute or a university department contributing to digital policy, and the roadmap reported under strategy names no research input.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	A first documented research workshop drew university lecturers, doctors, developers and students, with no funded programme behind it. Full record 2026-07-27 – the first documented workshop on artificial intelligence and data drew university lecturers, doctors, developers and students. No baseline was held and no funded programme, research centre or academic department is named. One convening by an alumni association is the whole of the country's research contribution to digital policy on this ledger. The national strategy's education and research pillar names no institution, and no university programme, publication or advisory body appears anywhere for the country.	Advanced
Comoros	A research institute delivered the country's first national data strategy through a continental project, validated in August 2026. Full record 2026-07 - the institute reconvened ministers, regulators, private sector, universities, researchers and development partners for a two-day review and collective validation of the draft strategy, after an initial capacity-building phase in May. 2026-08 - the strategy was validated, delivered through a joint African Union, European Union and German cooperation project after technical capacity-building on localising the continental data policy framework; it is the third the project has delivered, after the Gambia and Somalia. 2026-01 - separately, a peer-reviewed article examined integrating the Comorian vernacular into information-technology solutions across tourism, public administration, education and telecommunications, recommending a national language and culture laboratory and mobile-first design. The policy research on file is one foreign institute's and one article's.	Advanced
Djibouti	Academia joined the artificial-intelligence strategy workshop; no research programme in a digital field is on record. Full record This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one. The sole public university's own regional strategy is structured around training, research and governance, and the text held names no digital or data-science research programme. 2026-01-22 - the national artificial-intelligence strategy workshop of about eighty participants included academia alongside government, the United Nations, the private sector and civil society - the one recorded instance of academic contribution to digital policy. No think tank, no research centre mandate, no funded programme and no published research output in the field appears on file.	No change
Equatorial Guinea	Doctoral findings on big data, interoperability and digital identity were presented at the July 2026 forum, the only national research on record. Full record No research programme, funding line or publication is held (presentation). The national development strategy proposes a science, technology and innovation fund that may be financed by a special tax on oil and gas exports, and that fund does not exist, so one doctoral presentation is the whole of the research record.	Advanced
Eswatini	A university computer science department names a health-informatics research group and a cybersecurity and forensics group alongside a masters programme. Full record The department runs undergraduate and masters programmes in computer science, information technology and information science, and lists two research groups, one in health informatics and one in cybersecurity and forensics, with pages for publications and conferences and for research grants (department). It also hosts an ICT fair, a deep learning event and a hackathon, and acknowledges a development agency for sponsoring student data during remote teaching (activity). No funding line, output count or contribution to national digital policy is stated for either group, so what the department contributes to policy is not established.	No change

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	A university law school is drafting the online-infringement amendment with the intellectual property authority. Full record The amendment to the copyright proclamation is being drafted with the Addis Ababa University School of Law after several rounds of consultation (drafting). That is the whole of the record: no think tank, research centre or academic department is otherwise named as contributing to digital policy, and no commissioned research, submission or advisory appointment is held.	Advanced
Gambia	Cabinet approved a bill to establish a national research, development and innovation council (approval). Full record Cabinet approved a bill to establish a national research, development and innovation council (approval). The council does not yet exist.	Advanced
Ghana	A university white paper written with a professional institute and the cyber-security authority is the base's only academic contribution to digital policy. Full record It carries GH¢19.3m of cybersecurity-related losses for 2025 on 14,425 reports and 3,286 confirmed incidents recorded from January to September, figures that reach the record through the paper rather than through a published authority series (white paper). No think tank, research centre or standing academic advisory arrangement is otherwise named, and no commissioned research or policy submission is held.	Advanced
Lesotho	One joint review of digital public infrastructure with the national university's mathematics and computer science department is the whole of the record. Full record The ministry and the National University of Lesotho reviewed digital public infrastructure progress together on 20 February 2026 (review). No research programme, funding, publication or output has followed it into the base, and no other academic body or think tank is recorded contributing to digital policy.	No change
Libya	The one analytical contribution on file is the Seventh National Human Development Report, in preparation under a UNDP memorandum with the identity authority. Full record UNDP and the identity authority signed a memorandum on data systems and human development in July 2025 (memorandum), and the report was in preparation as at February 2026 (progress). No domestic think tank, university department or research centre is recorded contributing to digital policy, and the report itself has not been published.	No change
Madagascar	A university connectivity and artificial-intelligence initiative was announced in January 2026, with no campus connected or facility opened on record. Full record The initiative would bring high-speed internet and artificial intelligence to universities (initiative). Nothing has been recorded delivered under it since. No university department, research centre or think tank is recorded contributing to national digital policy, so the academic side of the record is an announcement and a funded skills line elsewhere in this ledger.	Advanced

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Malawi	A national research repository launched and a university project began evaluating language models in healthcare. Full record The dedicated institution is one: a not-for-profit company incorporated under the companies statute whose stated mission is independent digital-policy advocacy, consultancy and research. No publication, submission or funding figure for it is on file. 2026-02 - the research and education network launched a national federated repository with digital object identifier support, to raise the visibility of Malawian research output. 2026-04 - a university began a twelve-month project evaluating large language models for primary-healthcare settings, with the health ministry and the medical council. It is the only applied artificial-intelligence research with a government counterparty the base holds, and its findings are not yet on the record.	Advanced
Mali	The base holds no long-term national research strategic plan, and the higher-education digital framework validated in 2024 is the nearest thing to one. Full record The national higher-education and scientific research policy document of 2009 is the base's oldest source for the country, and it records no long-term research strategic plan and a teacher-student ratio of one to a hundred at the main university (policy). No think tank, research centre or university department is recorded contributing to national digital policy, and the sovereignty proposals adopted in 2026 were produced by a government week rather than by any research body.	Advanced
Mauritania	The university's computing and data sciences research unit lost its accreditation period in May 2024 with no renewal published, having held sixteen doctoral candidates. Full record The unit at the science and technology faculty was accredited for May 2021 to May 2024 and held sixteen doctoral candidates concentrated in artificial intelligence and data science, covering network optimisation, distributed-ledger and internet-of-things process mining, health-data management and cloud-resource elasticity, with three theses defended in 2022 (unit). The accreditation period ended in May 2024 with no renewal published. It is the only research capability on the country's digital questions in the base, and its formal standing lapsed two years ago.	Stalled
Morocco	A national research and innovation programme commits MAD 1bn across four editions to 2028, with no digital or artificial-intelligence share stated. Full record The programme has been in force since April 2025, funded jointly by the higher-education ministry and an industrial group, with MAD 1bn across four editions between 2025 and 2028 of which MAD 200m is directed at mobilising Moroccan researchers resident abroad (launch). The first edition's three sub-programmes, covering research and development, young researchers and technology transfer, opened for applications between June and October 2025 (call). No award or disbursement record is held, and no digital share of the fund is stated.	Advanced
Mozambique	The minister proposed transferring the research and education network from his ministry to the universities, with no date or instrument named. Full record The proposal was made at the university data-centre inauguration in August 2026, with no date, instrument or governance model named (proposal). It is the only recorded move to put a national digital asset under academic governance. No research programme, publication or think tank is otherwise recorded contributing to the country's digital policy.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Namibia	Three of the four UNESCO Chairs held in Namibia sit at the science and technology university, one of them in secure high-performance computing. Full record Only four UNESCO Chairs have been established in the country and three are housed at one university, their programmes covering water research for climate adaptation, gender and digital technologies, and secure high-performance computing for higher education and research (chairs). The university also hosts a bilateral centre of excellence in information technology and an earth observation and satellite applications research and training centre (listing). No publication record, funding line or policy output is attached to any of the chairs in the base, so what they contribute to digital policy is not established.	No change
Nigeria	An education-technology fellowship has supported 72 companies since 2019, and its fourth cohort funds education and workforce data systems in their own right. Full record The eighteen-month accelerator offers each company up to US\$100,000 in equity-free funding and structured technical assistance, with twelve startups in cohort four and 72 companies supported since 2019 (fellowship); the intake is targeted rather than open, across learners with disabilities, displacement-affected and rural communities, girls and young women, and education and workforce data systems, the fourth category funding sectoral education data infrastructure in its own right. The reach figure of more than 700,000 new learners is the hub's own (fellowship). A vendor-run academy sits inside a government skills initiative with a startup pitch competition and a developer bootcamp, its prize partly denominated in the sponsor's own advertising credits and no cohort size, curriculum or cost published (academy); a talent-export platform partnership has run since April 2025 (export).	Advanced
Rwanda	An African academic security operation centre operates through a university network based here, with no monitored-estate, incident or staffing figure published. Full record The centre runs through a university network based in the country (centre), and a continental research and education partnership carries a grant of about US\$9m from 2022 to 2027 with no progress or outturn report held at any date (partnership). An academic security operation centre is an unusual asset for a country of this size, and the absence of any operational figure means it cannot be counted as national cyber capacity in the readiness assessment recorded elsewhere.	Advanced
Senegal	Two artificial-intelligence research laboratories launched in January 2025 with three ministers present, and eighteen months have produced no follow-up item. Full record They are the only standing artificial-intelligence research infrastructure the base holds for the country, and no follow-up item has entered it in eighteen months (laboratories). A council of ministers communiqué proposes a national research and innovation fund alongside applied research laboratories, and none of the proposals is an adopted instrument (fund).	No change
Somalia	The national university launched an artificial-intelligence centre in July 2026, and a research partnership on official microdata closed a technical workshop with three partner universities. Full record The centre was launched in July 2026 (centre). The microdata partnership closed a three-day technical workshop with three partner universities in July 2026, opening official microdata to academic research (partnership). Neither states a staffing level, output or funding source. Together they are the country's entire research capacity on the record, and both were stood up in the same month.	Advanced

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The country places 18th worldwide and is the only African country in the top 20 for digital-privacy research output, on a review of 4,760 articles from 2005 to 2025. Full record 2026-08-18 — a bibliometric analysis of 4,760 articles over twenty years places the country 18th worldwide and the only African country in the top 20 for digital-privacy research output. It is the one place on this ledger where the country ranks near the top of anything. Two qualifications carried by the same review. It measures volume of output, not the coverage of the populations most exposed — refugees, people with disabilities, older people and racial and ethnic minorities are found notably underrepresented in that literature. And it is a first measurement here, with no earlier standing on the base to compare, so the level is stated and the direction is not. What the base does not hold is any link from that research capacity to policy: no research council submission, advisory panel or commissioned study appears in the instruments recorded elsewhere in this report.	No change, first measured in this window with nothing before it to compare
Tanzania	The country was selected as the sole national member of a global artificial-intelligence capacity development network. Full record The selection was announced in August 2026 (membership). No member institution, work programme, funding or obligation is named. It is the only research-capacity item in this unit that is not a building or a student cohort.	Advanced
Togo	A district and school data-use project entered its final phase, concluding in November 2026. Full record The start year is inferred from a three-year description and is not published (project). It is the only research activity in this ledger, and it studies whether education data is used at district and school level — which is the question the education management information system's own mid-migration state makes hard to answer.	No change
Zambia	The revenue authority signed a research memorandum and a non-disclosure agreement, so the terms — and whether taxpayer microdata moves — are not disclosed. Full record The memorandum and the accompanying non-disclosure agreement were signed in July 2026 (memorandum). A research agreement whose confidentiality clause conceals whether taxpayer microdata moves is worth recording as exactly that, in a country whose data-protection regulator has no recorded action. The domestic base has a date and a founding source: the university's computing and informatics department was established in September 1998 with Belgian development funding through a university cooperation programme, which paid for the refurbishment, the equipment and two networked laboratories across two five-year phases meant to end in self-sufficiency. It opened with a postgraduate diploma and admitted its first degree students in August 2000.	Advanced
Zimbabwe	The research council's 2023 and 2024 annual reports both confirm no gross research and development expenditure figure is published. Full record The absence is stated by the council's own annual reports, which is what makes it a finding rather than a gap in capture (2023, 2024). No research and development expenditure figure, and no share of gross domestic product, exists for this country in either report. Against an artificial-intelligence strategy proposing four institutions and a corpora programme led by universities, the country's own research council publishes no measure of what it spends on research.	Advanced

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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